presence would be necessary in the combat zone, so that they can motivate the troops, guide the formation and unit commanders, and get a feel of the ground.

The nurse told me that my wife, Rohini, was on the way and would be joining me soon. It was the best possible news I could have received and it made me feel brighter. On arrival, she gave me a lovely bouquet of roses, and her presence cheered me up no end. For a few hours it was just the two of us. Rohini was full of questions, and we kept talking.

Many years later I asked Anjaria, who had become a colonel by then, to give me an account of how he saw the events on that memorable day. This is an extract of what he had to say: 'Since the column of 2/11 GR was grossly under strength due to the numerous stops and ambushes already out, the QRT which arrived was most welcome. During the process of engaging the ANEs [anti-national elements] the Cdr, Brig JJ Singh, VSM was identified and spotted by the ANEs. A short burst of AK fire hit the Cdr in the groin. Despite being injured and bleeding profusely Brig JJ Singh, VSM continued to coordinate the operations and even spoke to the GOC 19 Mtn Div on the Radio Set.'

It is not in my nature to talk about this gunshot wound. But over the years, many people have wanted to know about my injury. Besides, it is rare for an officer of flag rank to get wounded in action against terrorists, and not every soldier is fortunate to be bloodied in battle. Therefore, this experience finds a place in this narrative.

The Lashkar-e-Toiba and other terrorist groups against whom we were pitted celebrated my 'killing'. It appears that they had already claimed the prize money for my scalp from their 'tanzeem'.

I rejoined my brigade instead of taking sick leave after being discharged from the hospital. The terrorists found it unbelievable, and thought it was not me but my ghost. Their masters across the border were livid. They ordered the divisional commander of the terrorists to return the claim money and warned him against giving false reports in future. At the same time, they were told to make